

LITO ZARATE BIALA

HANDS-ON AI BUILDER & ENTERPRISE AI PRODUCT LEAD | AGENTIC ENGINEERING · MCP · INCIDENT MANAGEMENT · SRE RELIABILITY · AI STRATEGY

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SUMMARY

Hands-on AI builder and enterprise AI product lead at Wells Fargo: I ship governed GenAI products end to end - problem framing, workflow design, hands-on implementation, evaluation suites, and stakeholder adoption - backed by 12+ years of leadership across people management and technical delivery. I find the bottlenecks that need AI, build the fix, and optimize the system - and I'm at my best making hard technical topics land with any audience while shaping the AI strategy that solves the business case. Reliability-first AI grounded in human review, evidence provenance, observability, and enterprise risk. Public, CI-verified evaluation portfolio at github.com/LZBiala - the build fails if a published claim drifts.

AI LEADERSHIP & TECHNICAL STRENGTHS

- **AI Product & Strategy:** use-case discovery, roadmap sequencing, requirements, acceptance criteria, adoption, stakeholder alignment.
- **GenAI & Agentic Systems:** RAG, LLM evaluation frameworks and evals, prompt/context engineering, MCP integration, agents, human-in-the-loop controls.
- **AI Engineering Delivery:** Python, Streamlit, TypeScript, GitHub, CI/CD, automated tests, code review, iterative PR-based delivery.
- **Reliability & Governance:** SRE, incident management, 5-Why/RCA, MTTx, observability, fail-closed behavior, AI risk and compliance readiness.
- **Agentic Build Tooling:** Claude Code, Codex, Devin - daily hands-on agentic system delivery with human-in-the-loop controls.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Vice President, Lead Digital Product Service Manager | Wells Fargo, Digital Technology & Innovation

Individual-contributor leadership role · Minneapolis, MN | Feb 2025 - Present

- **AI product delivery:** lead delivery of two governed AI products - an incident-notification quality assistant and a Daily 5-Why QA platform - turning operational pain points into buildable specs: requirements, evidence-source rules, versioned scoring rubrics, and acceptance tests, all gated by human review and grounded in SRE and DevOps best practices.
- **Hands-on build:** daily engineering with GitHub, Jira, Devin, VS Code Copilot, Python, Codex, and Claude Code - focused branches, pull requests, automated tests, coverage, linting, type checks, and protected-file audits for reviewable change.
- **Evidence architecture:** designed the evidence architecture pulling live incident and RCA data from ServiceNow and SharePoint: every record carries its provenance and passes schema validation; the system redacts diagnostics, fails closed on bad data, and requires explicit approval gates before touching production.
- **Responsible-AI boundaries:** established product boundaries that removed person-level scoring and identity from published score-bearing outputs - keeping names only for routing work to the right team and supporting 24-hour handoffs across global time zones.
- **Incident leadership:** lead major-incident, vulnerability-remediation, and operating-review readiness across distributed stakeholders; translate technical evidence into decision-ready impact, root-cause, detection-gap, mitigation, and preventive-action narratives. Years managing an API gateway platform made me the connective layer between Product, AppDev, DevOps, and governance.
- **AI enablement:** advance AI adoption through executive communication, pair programming, prompt-engineering enablement, technical documentation, and coaching on responsible human-in-the-loop delivery.

Senior Assistant Vice President, Digital Product Service Manager | Wells Fargo

Minneapolis, MN | Oct 2022 - Feb 2025

- **Reliability:** improved resiliency and uptime for customer-critical applications; reduced incident response times (MTTx) through proactive engineering, 5-why root-cause discipline, and DevOps practice.
- **Observability:** enhanced log-based alerting and monitoring through platform migrations (Splunk, Grafana), preserving operational continuity with executive-level service-health insight.
- **Platform delivery:** engineered foundational platforms for scale through cloud migration and data-center exit; led engineering release meetings across AppDev, Platform, and Product teams via CI/CD; guided distributed US/India engineering teams.

Senior Technology Business Systems Consultant | Wells Fargo, Digital Technology & Innovation

Jan 2022 - Oct 2022

- Kept digital information systems running smoothly under SRE, ITIL, and ITSM best practices; supported incident and problem management for production applications.

Software Product Analyst | Wells Fargo, Strategy, Digital & Innovation

Mar 2021 - Jan 2022

- Monitored health and status of internal APIs through dashboards and data solutions; analyzed historical trends to surface persistent performance issues.

Earlier people-leadership and operations roles - full history on LinkedIn.

PUBLIC AI EVALUATION & RELIABILITY PORTFOLIO - [GITHUB.COM/LZBIALA](https://github.com/LZBIALA) · [LZBIALA.GITHUB.IO](https://lzbiala.github.io)

- **wiki-memory-lab**: agent-memory evaluation framework; selective recall at 0.61× the tokens of the full-context baseline, with the loss trade-off (1.27×) measured and published rather than hidden.
- **agent-mutation-lab**: behavioral defect-detection harness; caught 9/10 planted defects with 0 false alarms on byte-identical clean controls; best-of-k voting study where panel accuracy tracks the exact binomial (Condorcet) prediction, with published controls showing when voting cannot help.
- **adversarial-chambers**: adversarial robustness evals; instruction-flip test - a scripted evidence-driven judge flips 0/8 verdicts, a scripted deferential judge flips 3/8, exactly the ambiguous items.
- **memory-repair-lab**: placebo-controlled self-repair evaluation; 8/10 → 10/10 on a held-out split sealed before generation zero.

All four are CI-verified on Windows and Linux: the build fails if any published claim drifts from regenerated data. Each ships an interactive walkthrough a stakeholder can click through.

TECHNOLOGY

AI/ML: Generative AI, RAG, agentic automation, LLM evaluation frameworks, prompt optimization, responsible AI, MCP, graph engineering, deep-wiki second-brain agentic systems · **Engineering**: Python, Streamlit, TypeScript, Git, GitHub, APIs, CI/CD, automated testing · **Operations**: Splunk, Grafana, observability, incident/problem management, 5-Why RCA, MTTx, ITIL · **Leadership**: AI product strategy, distributed-team leadership, technical writing, executive communication, risk and compliance · **Agentic tooling**: Claude Code, Codex, Devin (Cognition)

EDUCATION & CREDENTIALS

Data Analytics & Data Visualization Boot Camp Certificate, University of Minnesota Twin Cities · B.A. Psychology, Metropolitan State University

Splunk courses: Fundamentals 1-3 & Cloud Observability · Anthropic Academy course completions, 2026: Claude Code in Action · Introduction to Model Context Protocol · Wells Fargo internal SRE-leadership and AI-engineering program pathways